12.8 Treatment procedures

Recommended treatment depends on the stage and the actual type of the cancer. Treatment may include surgery, chemotherapy, radiation therapy or a combination of these.

Surgery

Surgery is performed to remove the tumor. If all of it is successfully removed and there are no metastases, surgery may be the only treatment required.

Chemotherapy

Chemotherapy involves the use of chemical substances to kill cancer cells. Chemotherapy may be administered intravenously. These drugs stop the cancer cells from multiplying.



Fig 12.6 Administration of chemotherapy

Some of the effects of chemotherapy include hair loss, reproductive changes, diarrhoea, malabsorption, nausea, vomiting and loss of sense of taste.

Radiation therapy



Fig 12.7 Administration of radiation therapy

The person receives specific doses of radiation at the cancerous areas of the body for a period of time. The aim of this treatment is to ensure that tumor cells do not grow again. It does not affect the entire body, as chemotherapy does. Healthy cells grow back after the treatment.

Activity : 2

Cancer Awareness Ribbons



Looped ribbons of different colours are used to create awareness on different types of cancers. Can you match the colours with the type of cancers they represent?

Pink loop	-	lung cancer
White loop	–	breast cancer
Yellow loop	–	cervical cancer
Teal loop	–	bone cancer
White and Teal loop	–	ovarian cancer

12.9 Nutrition related side effects of treatment

Some of the side effects of treatment procedures adopted in cancer that may hinder food intake are discussed as follows:

1. **Anorexia:** It is a common problem which may be minimized with a schedule of small meals and snacks.

2. **Fatty diarrhoea:** Radiation therapy may damage the cells of the small intestine leading to "fatty diarrhoea" also known as "steatorrhea" or "radiation enteritis" Dietary treatment involves limiting the intake of

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